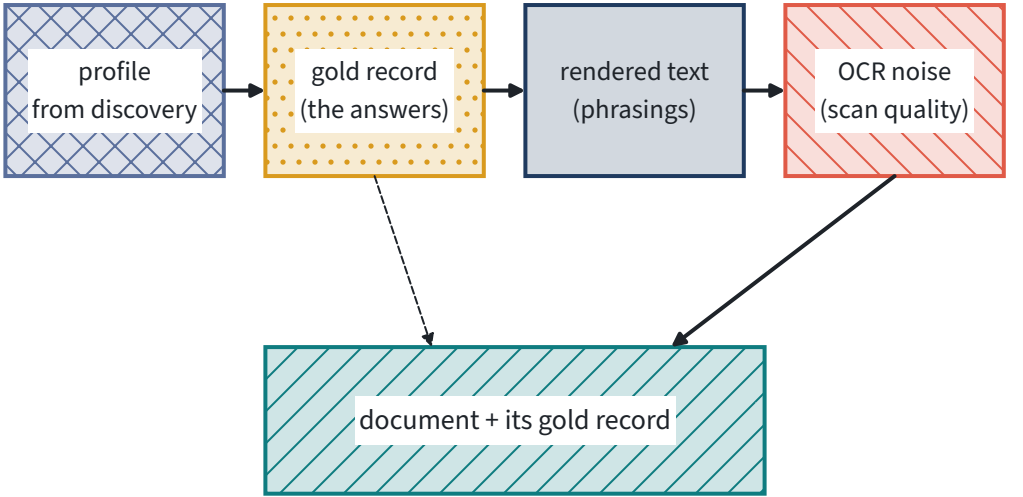the answer exists before the text does